

Session 1 — Live Delivery Script (CORRECTED for today's enriched session)

"Become the Analyst" · today · 60 min · no code · built for ~50

Facilitator: Deepti Bahel · **Co-host:** Lakshmi / Retail Women in Technology (chat + stragglers)

Dataset: your messy orders file ([retail_orders_messy.csv](#)) is the Session-1 spine. The three companion files ([retail_products.csv](#), [retail_customers.csv](#), [retail_returns.csv](#)) + [DATA_DICTIONARY.md](#) are the **level-up unlock** for fast finishers.

What changed from my first draft (all now fixed to your verified answer key):
real numbers (\$104K / 25% mobile / VIP 3.6× / etc.), the four-table level-up added, your five named mechanics, a dashboard deliverable, and the Session-2 bridge pointed at **web-based Claude Code (claude.ai/code)**, not a local terminal.

The one rule: participants make every call; Claude does the typing. "Should I drop this?" → "What do you think, and why?" — then let Claude execute.

Your five interactive mechanics (weave these throughout)

1. **Predict-then-reveal ×3.** Room commits a guess before each reveal; every guess gets subverted.
2. **The Anomaly Race.** First to find the \$999,999 row types **FOUND IT** in chat. 30 sec of energy.
3. **Pair-and-share.** Cleaning debates: "keep the sentinel row or kill it? Defend it."
4. **Headline wall.** Everyone posts their one-line headline in chat.
5. **Level-up unlock.** Fast finishers join the four files and find the buried margin story.

–10:00 to 0:00 · Doors-open (before the clock)

- ☐ Livestream + recording live. Slides on the dry-run's finished memo + dashboard as a north star.
- ☐ Pin in chat: link to [retail_orders_messy.csv](#), and "open claude.ai in a browser tab."

- ☐ Also pin (for fast finishers): the 3 companion CSVs + data dictionary, labeled "**Level-up files — don't open yet.**"
- ☐ Co-host: "Reply  when you have the orders CSV downloaded and claude.ai open."

SAY (rolling): "Download the orders file from the pin, open claude.ai. That's the whole setup — no code today. There's a bonus pack pinned too; ignore it for now, it's your reward for finishing early."

0:00–0:05 · Frame the mission

SAY: "Today *you* are the analyst — not Claude. Claude profiles, cleans, and calculates at your direction, but every judgment call is yours. One messy retail file, one job: find the real story under the mess and write it so a manager could act on it Monday. By the end you'll have a cleaned dataset, a one-page memo, and a dashboard — and you'll have caught something that fools most professionals."

 **Opening poll (30 sec):** "Hands or chat — who's ever renamed 'West / west / W' by hand in a spreadsheet?" (*Let the groans land.*) "Watch how fast this goes."

Transition: "Fresh Claude chat, upload the orders CSV. Co-host's dropping prompt 1 now."

0:05–0:12 · Meet the data (profile — no fixing)

PASTE — Prompt 1:

I've uploaded a retail orders dataset. Before changing anything, give me a plain-English profile: how many rows and columns, what each column means, and the top data-quality problems you notice. Don't fix anything yet — just tell me what's wrong, worst first.

WATCH: ~930 rows × 14 cols; a column glossary; issues named — mixed date formats, 12 region spellings for 4 regions, ~10 encodings of Returned, \$ in prices, blanks, duplicate rows.

 **Trust-builder (30 sec):** "Hands up — Claude flagged a problem you'd have missed?" (Name one: the invisible trailing spaces in Category that'd silently break a group-by.)

IF IT WOBBLES: Upload fails → co-host 1:1; room keeps moving.

0:12–0:20 · Interrogate, then the trap (Predict-then-reveal #1)

PASTE — Prompt 2:

Show me every distinct value with its count for the Region, ProductCategory, and

Returned columns. I want to see the inconsistencies myself.

WATCH: 12 spellings → 4 regions; case/space Category variants; ~10 Returned encodings.

⚡ **PREDICT #1 (before running Prompt 3):** "Commit in chat: which region made the most revenue? Guess now." (15 sec — *commitment makes the reveal land.*)

PASTE — Prompt 3 (the trap, on RAW data):

On this data as-is, which region generated the most revenue, and by how much?

Give me a quick ranked table.

WATCH: West looks wildly dominant. DO NOT CORRECT IT. Let it sit.

SAY: "West isn't just winning, it's *crushing* everyone. Hold that too-dramatic feeling — we'll come back to it."

0:20–0:30 · The catch (the peak — slow down) · Anomaly Race

PASTE — Prompt 4:

That West total looks suspiciously large versus the others. Find the specific rows

driving it and show them to me — I want to see the actual records.

WATCH: **ORD50357** — a \$12.88 ceramic mug with Revenue = \$999,999, sitting in West / Home / September. One row invents the whole "West / Home / September" story.

⚡ **ANOMALY RACE:** "First to find it types **FOUND IT** in chat — order ID and what's wrong."

When it lands — STOP. This is the emotional peak. SAY: "A

twelve-dollar-and-eighty-eight-cent mug... with revenue keyed as nine hundred ninety-nine thousand dollars. That's not a sale — that's a finger slip. And that ONE row invented a business conclusion a VP could've put in a board deck. The real question isn't technical: is it a real sale or a typo — and *who decides what we do with it?* You do. That's the job."

 **PAIR-AND-SHARE (90 sec):** "Neighbor or chat: keep this row 'just in case,' or kill it? Defend your call." (*Someone will argue keep — perfect. The point is a human chose, on the record.*)

IF IT WOBBLES: Sentinel won't surface → "sort by Revenue descending, show the top 5 rows."

0:30–0:40 · Clean it — participant makes every call
(Predict-then-reveal #2)

PASTE — Prompt 5:

Let's clean this together. Walk through these one at a time and ask me to confirm

before applying each:

1. Standardize Region to West / East / South / Midwest.
2. Fix ProductCategory (case + trailing spaces) to clean categories.
3. Convert Returned to a clean Yes/No.
4. Convert Discount to decimals (15% -> 0.15); leave blanks as unknown.
5. Strip \$ from prices; fix the one negative price.
6. Parse all dates into one ISO format (YYYY-MM-DD).
7. Remove exact duplicate rows.
8. Quarantine impossible values (the \$999,999 revenue row and the quantity-999 row)

instead of analyzing them.

For blank Revenue, recompute it as $\text{UnitPrice} \times \text{Quantity} \times (1 - \text{Discount})$.

Keep a short log of every change you make.

WATCH: Confirms each fix; quarantines (not deletes) the sentinel; recomputes blank Revenue; keeps a change log. Lands at **~821 clean rows**.

SAY at each step: "Agree, or handle it differently?" And on the log: "That change log is your credibility — when a manager asks 'what did you do to my data?', you show receipts, not 'trust me.'"

⚡ **PREDICT #2 (before re-analyzing):** "We're about to re-run the region question on the *clean* data. Commit: does West still dominate — yes or no?"

IF IT WOBBLES: Claude does it all at once → "tell it 'stop after each step and wait for my confirm.'" Blanks dropped instead of recomputed → "recompute blank Revenue, don't drop those rows."

0:40–0:50 · Re-analyze — find the REAL headline · Headline wall

PASTE — Prompt 6:

Now, on the CLEANED data, give me short tables for:

- revenue by region
- revenue by product category
- return rate by channel
- return rate by product category
- average order value by customer segment
- return rate for orders discounted over 30% vs everything else

WATCH / ANSWER-KEY CHECKPOINT (your verified numbers):

- **Regions balanced now:** West **\$34K** · East **\$28K** · South **\$24K** · Midwest **\$18K**. *West's dominance vanished the instant the mug left.* (Predict #2 payoff.)
- **Return rate by channel:** Mobile App **~25%** · Online **~10%** · In-Store **~8%**.
- **Footwear: #1 in revenue AND ~20% return rate** — a margin leak.
- **AOV by segment:** VIP **~\$312** vs Returning **~\$116** vs New **~\$87 (~3.6×)**.

- **Deep discounts:** orders discounted **>30% return ~37%** vs ~10% otherwise.
- **Totals:** **≈ \$104K** revenue · AOV **≈ \$126** · overall return **≈ 12%** · **no real seasonality** (flat ~\$7–11K/mo once the sentinel's gone).

PASTE — Prompt 7:

What's the single most surprising, actionable finding here that a retail operations

manager would want on Monday morning? Explain why it matters and show the numbers behind it.

 **HEADLINE WALL:** "Everyone posts ONE headline sentence in chat, with the number behind it. This is the skill — turning a table into a decision."

SAY (validate live): "The strongest operational headline is Mobile App returns — one in four orders comes back, ~3× In-Store. Real money leaking through the app, and it's fixable. Footwear's revenue-vs- returns tension and VIP value are legit leads too — pick yours, defend it, show the group-by."

0:50–0:58 · Ship it — memo + dashboard

PASTE — Prompt 8 (memo):

Write a one-page insight memo for a retail operations lead: a headline finding, 3 supporting

insights with numbers, one data-quality caveat (what we cleaned and quarantined), and 2

recommended actions. Plain business language, one page. Then give me the cleaned dataset as a

downloadable CSV and the memo as a downloadable file.

PASTE — Prompt 9 (dashboard):

Build a simple self-contained HTML dashboard for these findings: KPI cards (total revenue, AOV,

overall return rate, Mobile App return rate) and bar charts for return rate by channel and by

category. Accent only the Mobile App / Footwear bars; keep the rest neutral. One file, no server.

SAY: "Notice the caveat line in the memo — telling the reader what you cleaned and set aside is what separates an analyst from a chart generator. Honesty is a feature."

IF IT WOBBLES (free tier): Download won't generate → copy the memo text + table; "next week's agents write real files." Don't burn clock.

⚡ **Deliverable check:** "Thumbs up in chat if you have three things: cleaned CSV, one-page memo, dashboard."

★ LEVEL-UP UNLOCK (fast finishers, runs in parallel; surface the reveal to the room if time allows)

SAY (to whoever's done early): "Unlock the bonus pack — upload `retail_products.csv`, `retail_customers.csv`, and `retail_returns.csv` into your chat."

⚡ **PREDICT #3:** "Before you join anything — which category do you think is your most profitable?" *(Everyone says Footwear, the revenue leader. Let them.)*

PASTE — Level-up prompt:

I've uploaded three more files: products (with unit cost + margin), customers (with acquisition channel), and returns (with reasons + refund amounts). Join them to my orders and tell me:

1. True net contribution by product category after netting margin against refunds — which category

actually MAKES money and which LOSES money?

2. The #1 refund reason and which channel it concentrates in.

3. Which acquisition channels VIP customers came from.

Show the numbers behind each.

WATCH / THE REVEAL:

- **Footwear leads revenue (\$36K) but is the ONLY money-LOSING category (−\$850 net)** after its thin 17% margin and \$6.9K in refunds. **Apparel is the real profit leader (−\$9.3K)**; Beauty & Accessories are quiet high-margin winners.

- **"Wrong size / poor fit"** is the #1 refund driver (~\$5K), concentrated in **Mobile App** → *explains* the 25% mobile return rate. Action: add a size guide to the app.
- **~81% of VIPs came from Referral + Email**; New customers skew to Paid Social (high returns, low value). Action: shift spend to referral.

SAY (the reframe — the line that justifies four tables): "Revenue is vanity. Contribution margin is sanity. The category that looks like your best performer is quietly losing money — and you can *only* see it when you join the files. That's what a data team does that a spreadsheet can't."

0:58–1:00 · Bridge to Session 2 (CORRECTED — web-based Claude Code)

SAY: "In under an hour, no code, you took a broken file, caught an anomaly that fools professionals, made every cleaning call yourself, found the real story, and shipped a memo *and* a dashboard. That's not 'using Claude' — that's being an AI data analyst."

SAY (the hook, accurate to your plan): "Next week we don't do this by hand. We build a Claude Code project **in your browser at claude.ai/code — no terminal, no installs** — that connects to a GitHub repo and does all of this from a single `/analyze` command: four reusable Skills (data-quality, data-modeling, insight-generation, reporting-style), a data-quality-reviewer that double-checks the work, and a `CLAUDE.md` that holds your judgment. Same thinking you used today, captured once, running on any file."

SAY (pre-work — say it clearly, it's different from what people expect): "To join next week you need a **Claude Pro or Max plan** and a **free GitHub account** — that's it. No Node, no terminal. The pre-work email has the two links. See you next week."

Facilitator quick-reference card (keep visible)

Must-hit checkpoints: ① wrong "West wins" on raw data · ② the \$999,999 mug reveal · ③ West going normal after cleaning · ④ Mobile App returns headline · ⑤ (level-up) Footwear = the money loser.

Answer key at a glance (your verified file): | Metric | Value | |---|---| | Total revenue (clean) | ≈ \$104K | | AOV | ≈ \$126 | | Overall return rate | ≈ 12% | | Mobile / Online / In-Store returns | ~25% / ~10% / ~8% | | Footwear | #1 revenue, ~20% return | | VIP / Returning / New AOV | ~\$312 / ~\$116 / ~\$87 (VIP ~3.6× New) | | Discount >30% → return | ~37% vs ~10% | | Regions (clean) |

West \$34K · East \$28K · South \$24K · Midwest \$18K | | Clean row count | ~821 | | Seasonality | none — flat \$7-11K/mo | | Sentinel | ~~ORD50357~~ — \$12.88 mug, \$999,999, West/Home/Sept | | **Level-up: true contribution | Footwear — \$850 (only loser); Apparel — +\$9.3K (real leader)** | | Level-up: #1 refund reason | "wrong size/fit", concentrated in Mobile App (\$5K) | | Level-up: VIP acquisition | ~81% from Referral + Email |

Recovery one-liners: upload fails → co-host 1:1 · sentinel hiding → "sort by Revenue desc, top 5" · Claude fixes all at once → "stop after each step, wait for my confirm" · download won't generate → copy text out, "Session 2 writes real files" · someone spoils the anomaly early → "you might be right — let's *prove* it, not guess it."

Session-2 pre-work (repeat at the close): Claude **Pro/Max** plan + a free **GitHub** account. No Node, no terminal.

Protect the clock, keep every decision in the room, and let them catch the mug themselves.